

AI Infrastructure And The Power System Reset (2026)

U.S. DC load 2023	176 TWh	Large and growing share of demand
U.S. DC load 2028 range	325-580 TWh	High planning uncertainty
U.S. sales growth 2026	1%	Demand recovery continuation
U.S. sales growth 2027	3%	Step-up year

Executive Agenda And Decision Flow

Signals	Validated demand baseline	CEO/CFO
Constraints	Bottleneck map	COO
Options	Tradeoff decision	Strategy office
Execution	Quarterly roadmap	PMO

Executive Synthesis

Demand growth	Re-accelerating	Plan for high case
Queue certainty	Low-moderate	Prioritize certainty zones
Mix resilience	Uneven by market	Diversify by design
Execution readiness	Fragmented	Single governance model

Demand Signals (2024-2028)

LBNL historical load	58 to 176 TWh	High
LBNL 2028 range	325-580 TWh	Medium
EIA 2026 growth	1%	Medium-High
EIA 2027 growth	3%	Medium

System Capacity And Queue Reality

Interconnection queue	High	Early queue strategy
Transmission upgrades	High	Joint utility planning
Permitting	Medium-High	Parallel approval tracks
Critical equipment	Medium	Long-lead procurement

Generation Mix Implications

Gas-heavy	High	Medium-High	Low-Medium
Balanced mix	High	Medium	Medium
Renewable-heavy	Medium	Low-Medium	High

Strategic SWOT For Hyperscale Build Programs

Queue uncertainty	Certainty-weighted sequencing	Strategy + PMO
Policy shifts	Scenario triggers	Finance
Execution delays	Integrated program controls	Operations
Supply concentration	Portfolio diversification	Energy team

Top Risks And Mitigations

Queue delay	High	High	Dual-track interconnection strategy
Transmission lag	High	High	Utility partnership plan
Permitting delay	Medium	High	Parallel permitting tracks
Capex inflation	Medium	Medium-High	Indexed procurement strategy

12-Quarter Execution Roadmap

Q1-Q2	Scenario and siting complete	Approved priority map
Q3-Q4	Permits and procurement	>=80% critical path secured
Y2	Build and integrate	Schedule variance <10%
Y3	Optimize and expand	Availability and ROI targets met

Recommendations And Next Decisions

1	Approve scenario framework	CEO/CFO	30 days
2	Finalize priority regions	Strategy/Ops	60 days
3	Launch mitigation programs	PMO	90 days
4	Implement gate governance	Exec committee	Quarterly